



Need Greater Regulatory Safeguards

The recent allegations against Buch, though lacking in substance, present a valuable opportunity for India to reevaluate how it safeguards its regulatory officials

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IN RECENT MONTHS, efforts have been made to cast doubt on the integrity of the Chairperson of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), Madhabi Puri Buch. Allegations of conflict of interest have emerged, suggesting Buch has connections to offshore entities linked to the Adani Group, a conglomerate under investigation for securities fraud. These claims insinuate that Buch's financial interests could potentially compromise her role as Sebi chief.

However, a deeper analysis reveals that these allegations lack substantial evidence. The nature of Sebi's decision-making process, the structure of financial regulations, and Buch's leadership record suggest that these claims are not only unproved, but part of a broader attempt to undermine a competent regulator.

LACK OF EVIDENCE

One of the key issues with the allegations is the absence of credible evidence. While the accusations centre on possible ties to offshore entities connected to the Adani Group, no specific financial gain or influence has been demonstrated. In fact, none of Sebi's actions or investigations appears to have been influenced by Buch's alleged con-

